Innovating Toward the Future

From Last April's Roadmap to Today's Platform

SYNC 2026 | Opening Keynote | Jim Funari, CEO

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SYNC Beyond Data: AI for Human Connection

StratusLIVE

Agenda

- **Continuity** — where we left off at SYNC 2025 and the direction we set
- **Confirmation** — what a year of listening, market research, & signals validated
- **Capacity** — the AI development acceleration that increased our capacity
- **Capabilities –** so what's new in the products **?**
- Demo

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Where We Left Off

At SYNC 2025, we showed you a direction. Today we show you where it led.

At SYNC 2025, We Made Four Commitments

Each became a delivered platform capability. Here is where the roadmap pointed — and where it led.

Agentic AI

We committed to AI that acts — not just suggests. Today, Ignite Intelligence provides the framework and capability to use AI throughout the platform to provide insights, guidance, and task execution.

Ignite Constituents, Profiles & AI Action Plans

We committed to a native constituent layer in Ignite with profile views, activity history, and strategic AI insights for each person. Today that is Ignite CRM — AI-native, relationship-first, built for the fundraiser.

Ignite Finance

We committed to financial processing built natively in Ignite — with AI Assistants, an Excel-like gift entry interface, and a consumer-grade experience. Today that is Ignite Finance: full subledger, batch control, GL integration — delivered.

Ignite Give at Work

We committed to a lighter, Ignite-native CSR and workplace giving solution using the same platform tools as all other digital engagement methods. Today that is Ignite Give at Work — available now.

Four Streams Converged with Clear Confirmations.

Your Voice

NPS verbatims, CS meeting notes, and enhancement requests — synthesized by AI

Market Voice

AI-enabled research across 2,000+ nonprofits and the competitive landscape — confirming the needs and direction

Our Capacity

A transformed engineering team — what AI-accelerated development made possible

MS Signal

A careful read of where Microsoft is taking Dynamics 365 — and what it means for you

Each confirmed what we pointed to at SYNC 2025. None redirected us. Together they accelerated us.

What You Told Us — Five Findings

Two years of NPS verbatims, CS conversations, and enhancement requests — synthesized by AI. Five themes with striking consistency.

01 **Simpler, More Intuitive Experiences**

Fundraisers want tools they actually enjoy using — not systems they tolerate. Consumer-grade UX is no longer a 'nice to have.'

02 **AI That Acts, Not Just Suggests**

The ask is for AI embedded in workflows — a participant that executes tasks, not a badge on a dashboard waiting to be consulted.

03 **Deeper Connection Between Engagement and the Constituent Record**

Digital engagement data must be visible where relationship decisions are made. A gift officer should never need two systems to understand one donor.

04 **Faster Delivery**

Shorter cycles from asking to receiving. Enhancement requests measured in months or years are no longer acceptable when the landscape moves in weeks.

05 **A Platform That Grows Without Growing More Complex**

Organizations want to add capability — not administrative overhead, configuration debt, or technical staff to manage the growth.

A Question Before We Go Further

Think about your constituents and donors.
How many of you hear directly from them about their digital experience with you?

✓

Yes — regularly through surveys, calls, or direct feedback

~

Sometimes — we get it but haven't formalized the channel

○

Rarely — it comes in anecdotally but we don't capture it

✗

Not really — we assume we know, but we don't have a system

We asked the same question of ourselves — about you. And what we heard changed our entire strategy.

2

What the Market Confirmed

Independent market research confirmed the direction we had already chosen — and sharpened our understanding of the gap.

What the Market Told Us — Five Signals

Independent research across 2,000+ mid-market nonprofits — five themes, each pointing to the same architectural gap.

01 **Point Solutions Cause Friction**

Disconnected platforms force staff to manually bridge gaps that should not exist. Every integration point is a failure point — and most organizations have too many of them.

02 **User Experiences Are Clunky and Dated**

Interfaces that felt modern in 2010 now feel like friction. Staff compare their work tools to the apps they use at home — and the tools lose.

03 **Reporting Doesn't Drive Action**

Dashboards exist. Actionable insight does not. Analytics are hard to tailor and disconnected from the workflows where decisions are made.

04 **Integrating with ERP / Accounting Is Painful**

The boundary between gift processing and general ledger remains one of the most cited sources of manual effort, reconciliation errors, and staff frustration.

05 **AI Must Act — Not Just Suggest — Under Human Control**

The hope for AI isn't smarter reports. It's an agent that can take the next step on behalf of a fundraiser — with appropriate human oversight and authorization.

The Gap Is Real

Goldilocks

Budgets, needs, and scale of many organizations are:

Too complex for small tools,

Too lean for big, enterprise configurations

AI-First

Almost nothing in this segment was designed AI-native. Most tools add AI as a layer. None were built around it.

73%

of these organizations use 3 or more disconnected platforms — each knowing only a fragment of their constituents

Now

The window to build AI-ready infrastructure is open. It will not stay open indefinitely.

These organizations deserve a platform designed for them — not a scaled-down Tailored tool or a scaled-up small business app.

The Microsoft Signal — What We Observed

Microsoft's direction is the right fit for some nonprofits — and a questionable fit for others. Understanding which you are is a strategic decision.

	Microsoft's Objectives	Impact on Nonprofits
AI & Cloud Consolidation	Heavy investment in Copilot, Power Platform, Fabric, and Azure AI — consolidating around the Microsoft Cloud as the primary delivery surface.	Larger organizations with genuine Microsoft dependency have a credible, supported path forward. Deep Microsoft investment is a real asset.
Dynamics 365 Repositioned	Dynamics 365 is increasingly one component in a broader Microsoft Cloud strategy — not a standalone CRM offering.	Small-to-Mid nonprofits find less dedicated investment in CRM-specific nonprofit capability — the roadmap is shaped by commercial B2B priorities.
Revenue Model Shifting	Licensing economics evolving toward consumption and bundle pricing — more flexibility for large enterprises, more cost complexity for smaller organizations.	Organizations face growing complexity and cost without commensurate nonprofit-specific value in return.
B2C Scale Not the Core Assumption	Core CRM architecture remains built for commercial B2B workflows — not for the high-volume, B2C constituent model that nonprofits operate.	High constituent volume at nonprofit scale requires workarounds. AI-native capabilities require significant additional configuration for nonprofit workflows.
The Right Response	Microsoft's trajectory is driven by enterprise and commercial software priorities — and delivers real value to organizations deeply embedded in that ecosystem.	**Honest strategic assessment on our part and similar evaluation on your part.**

3

What Our Team Became Capable Of

In the last 12 months — and especially the last 5 — something changed inside StratusLIVE.

The Productivity Inflection

12 mo

The period in which AI-assisted development transformed our engineering output

5–6 mo

The window of most dramatic acceleration — where velocity changed structurally, not incrementally

“2025-2035

is the decade of agents.”

Andrej Karpathy

AI Startup School, June 2025 — “Software has remained largely unchanged for nearly 70 years. But in just the past few years, it has undergone not one, but two dramatic shifts.”

We experienced this inflection firsthand. Our capacity increased. So, what do we do with increased capacity?

We Said It. We Built It.

At SYNC 2025 we showed you the direction. Today the vision is reality and we'll see it momentarily.

01

Ignite CRM

At SYNC 2025: "brand new to Ignite — a Constituent Profile view." Today: delivered. AI-native CRM with 360-degree profiles, relationship mapping, and predictive scoring.

02

Ignite Finance

At SYNC 2025: "brand new — financial processing in the Ignite interface, with AI Assistants and an Excel-like gift entry paradigm." Today: delivered. Full subledger, GL integration, clean consumer UI.

03

Ignite Intelligence

At SYNC 2025: "delivering strategic AI insights and strategies for each constituent — simple, clean, informative." Today: delivered as four active agents executing across all three platform layers.

04

Tailored Experience Evolution Path

The Tailored Experience evolution path — structured, paced, built with Microsoft direction and your input. Designed to respect what you have built and the timeline that serves your mission.

4

Choice

Two architecturally coherent paths. One commitment to both.

No mandatory transitions! True choice. Stay where you are. Or explore.

Choose Your Experience

Two purpose-built platforms. One vision. Both powered by Ignite Intelligence AI.

	StratusLIVE 365 CRM **Tailored Experience** The platform adapts to you	StratusLIVE Ignite **Guided Experience** The platform elevates you
Best Fit	**Complex orgs with dedicated IT** Large teams, multi-entity structures, Microsoft ecosystem investments	**Mission-focused teams without IT overhead** Lean fundraising teams needing built-in intelligence and immediate productivity
Philosophy	**You define the process — we provide the tools** Deep configuration, custom workflows, extensibility aligned to your operational model	**We embed best practices — you focus on relationships** Prescriptive workflows, AI-guided processes encoding how top nonprofits operate
AI & Intelligence	**Ignite Intelligence across your custom configuration** Configuration of native MS Agent architecture or Ignite Intelligence w/D365 CRM.	**Ignite Intelligence woven into every workflow natively** AI surfaces opportunities and executes tasks from day one — no setup required
Architecture	**Microsoft Dynamics 365 & Dataverse** D365, PowerPlatform, Fabric, Teams, Outlook — enterprise security & extensibility	**Modern cloud-native microservices** .NET 10, PostgreSQL, Kafka, Snowflake — consumer-grade UX, no legacy dependencies
User Experience	**Powerful and configurable** Full control over forms, views, dashboards — designed for power users	**Consumer-grade and intuitive** Mobile-first interface — every team member productive in hours, not weeks
IT Requirements	**IT-supported deployment** Internal IT or partner manages configuration, security, and platform governance	**No internal IT required** Self-service admin, automatic updates, managed security — we run the platform
Time to Value	**Phased implementation, custom scoping** Tailored deployment — typically 3–6 months with discovery, configuration, training	**Rapid onboarding with guided migration** Pre-configured conversions — live in 2 - 3 months

Two Paths. One Ecosystem.

Every capability on both paths. The difference is in how the platform delivers it.

	Tailored, Configurable StratusLIVE 365 CRM	Guided, Prescriptive StratusLIVE Ignite
CRM	StratusLIVE 365 CRM on Dynamics 365	Ignite CRM
Opportunity Mgmt	StratusLIVE 365 CRM on Dynamics 365	Ignite Fundraising
Marketing	DotDigital Marketing Automation	Ignite Marketing
Finance	StratusLIVE 365 CRM or Ignite Finance	Ignite Finance
Online Engagement	Ignite	Ignite
↳ Donation Pages, P2P, Team	Ignite Fundraising	Ignite Fundraising
↳ Events	Ignite Engagement	Ignite Engagement
↳ Volunteers	Ignite Engagement	Ignite Engagement
↳ Community Groups	Ignite Engagement	Ignite Engagement
↳ Partnerships	Ignite Partnerships	Ignite Partnerships
Self-Service / Donor Hub	Ignite Self-Service	Ignite Self-Service
Workplace Giving	Give at Work Enterprise	Ignite Give at Work
Agentic AI	Ignite Intelligence *	Ignite Intelligence

* Evaluating full Ignite Intelligence capabilities for the Microsoft-centric path

Which Experience Fits You?

Read each description. The one that sounds like your organization is your path.

StratusLIVE 365 CRM

TAILORED EXPERIENCE

This might be you if…

✓ You have established processes you need the platform to support

✓ Your IT team actively manages your technology stack

✓ You've invested in the Microsoft ecosystem — Power Platform, Azure, or Fabric

✓ Your reporting and compliance requirements need deep customization

✓ You need the platform to conform to how you already operate

✓ Your organization raises $15 mil or more and manages significant complexity

StratusLIVE Ignite

GUIDED EXPERIENCE

This might be you if…

✓ You want the platform to show you the best way to work

✓ Your team wears multiple hats and cannot afford a steep learning curve

✓ You'd rather have AI handle the analysis so your team focuses on donors

✓ You want to be live fast and improving immediately

✓ You're raising $3M or more and ready for an AI-native platform built for your scale

✓ You're coming from legacy products and want a modern alternative without the complexity

Shared Across Both Experiences:

- Ignite Intelligence AI
- Ignite Digital Fundraising
- Donor Hub
- Give at Work CSR
- Ignite Partnerships

Ignite — The Active Intelligence Platform

Eight modules. One data model. One constituent identity. AI that knows your donors completely.

Ignite CRM

The Fundraiser's Command Center

Complete constituent lifecycle management — 360° profiles, AI-powered insights, relationship mapping, and predictive engagement scoring.

Ignite Fundraising

Every Revenue Stream. One Engine.

Individual, corporate, and digital philanthropy unified — opportunity management, moves management, pipeline tracking, and goal planning.

Ignite Finance

From Donation to Financial Statement

Full gift processing, financial subledger, GL integration, reconciliation, and compliance — donation to journal entry in one system.

Ignite Marketing

Personalization at Scale

Multi-channel orchestration — email, SMS, social — built on unified CRM data with AI-powered personalization and journey automation.

Ignite Engagement

Events. Volunteers. Community.

Events, volunteers, and community groups with digital registration, scheduling, hour tracking, and constituent-facing experiences.

Ignite Partnerships

Connected to the Giving Ecosystem

Multi-stakeholder platform connecting nonprofits, corporate CSR, foundations, and federated fundraisers on shared community philanthropy.

Ignite Intelligence

Your AI-Powered Fundraising Team

Platform-native agentic AI delivering intelligence, guidance, task execution, and digital labor — operating 24/7 across all three layers.

Ignite Self-Service

The Constituent's Command Center

Personalized constituent portal where donors view impact, manage giving, access statements, and update preferences — fully branded.

See It In Action

Three moments that show what the Guided Experience feels like from the inside.

01

Ignite CRM — The 360° Constituent View

A gift officer opens a constituent record before a major donor call. Everything is there — giving history, engagement signals, AI Action Plan, next best action — in a single clean view. No second system. No manual prep.

▶ Demo: constituent profile + AI Action Plan

02

Ignite Finance — Gift Entry Reimagined

A gift entry operator opens a batch. The Excel-like interface loads instantly. AI Assistants pre-fill expected fields, flag anomalies, and suggest GL coding. A task that took 45 minutes now takes 12.

▶ Demo: batch gift entry with AI Assistants

03

Ignite Intelligence — An Agent in Action

The Prospect Research Agent researches and qualifies both individual and corporate prospects for alignment with the organization's mission. It qualifies, prepares briefing reports, develops cultivation and ask strategies, and answers your questions.

▶ Demo: Relationship Intelligence agent workflow

Our Commitments to You

01

We promised — and we delivered what we said was coming.

At SYNC 2025 we previewed Constituent Profiles, AI Action Plans, and Ignite Finance. Every one of those previews is a delivered platform capability today.

02

We are investing in both paths — with equal seriousness.

The Microsoft-centric path and the Ignite-centric path both receive sustained engineering investment. This is not a holding pattern on either side.

03

The Ignite Active Intelligence Platform is arriving for preview this quarter (Q2 2026).

Ignite CRM, Ignite Finance, and Ignite Intelligence are entering preview for select Guided Experience organizations this quarter. The AI development acceleration compressed years into 12 months. Your opportunity to be first begins now.

04

Your migration path will be built with you — not announced to you.

Tailored Experience customers: the Client Evaluation Program program shapes the migration framework. You will have direct input into the tools, timeline, and transition approach.

We Said It. You Waited. It's Here.

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